Poem of Gilgameš – Old Babylonian IM: “[…]”

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- Source: eBL corpus – https://www.ebl.lmu.de/corpus/L/1/4/Old%20Babylonian/IM
- API: https://www.ebl.lmu.de/api/texts/L/1/4/chapters/Old%20Babylonian/IM/display
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Per line: **N** = normalized Akkadian reconstruction (`|` metrical foot, `||` caesura); **T** = eBL English translation; **L** = lemmas with eBL dictionary glosses; then notes, parallel lines, and the manuscripts' transliterations (ATF). Bibliography keys like [RN117: 889] are resolved in `bibliography.md` (RN117 = George 2003).

1

- **N:** […]
- **T:** […]

```
BabaOB1 o 1. [x x x x x x x x x x x]
```

2

- **N:** […] | ubbalūnim
- **T:** […] *they bring*.
- **L:** *ubbalūnim* ← wabālu I “(*cf.* also *babālu*) to carry, bring”

```
BabaOB1 o 2. [x x x x x x] u₂#-ba#-lu#-nim?#
```

3

- **N:** […] | qištim
- **T:** […] forest,
- **L:** *qištim* ← qištu I “pl. *qišātu(m)* forest, wood *q. erēnim* cedar forest”

```
BabaOB1 o 3. [x x x x x x] qi₂-iš-tim
```

4

- **N:** [… | qāt]ī | iṣṣabtū
- **T:** […] they held (hands?).
- **L:** *qāt]ī* ← qātu I “f.”; *iṣṣabtū* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”

```
BabaOB1 o 4. [x x x x x qa?-t]i iṣ-ṣa-ab-tu
```

5

- **N:** […] … […] …
- **T:** […] …

```
BabaOB1 o 5. [x x x] ab x [x x] x ha x x-at-tim
```

6

- **N:** […] … | i niwšib | wēdāni
- **T:** […] and let us sit down on our own.
- **L:** *i* ← i I “let's”; *niwšib* ← ašābu I “to sit (down)”; *wēdāni* ← ēdēnu I “alone M/NB + pers. suff. e.g. *ēdēnukka*, *ēdēnuššu* on his own”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 270]: “The variants *ni-ú-ši-ib* and *ni-ši-ib* for the expected *nūšib* seem to suggest an exceptional cohortative *i niwšib/nīšib*, analogous with *i nipqid*. I assume *wēdāni* to be an OB adverb comparable with SB *ēdāniš* (*Ludlul* I 79). It can be added to the adverbs collected by [farber1982altbabylonische: 37–47]; see further [RN1419: 198 on 48].”

```
BabaOB1 o 6. [x x] x-ma i ni#-u₂-ši-ib we-da-ni
```

7

- **N:** […] … | kakkab | …
- **T:** […] *star*…

- **L:** *kakkab* ← kakkabu I “star also ref. to planets”

```
BabaOB1 o 7. [x x x] x ka-uk?-ka-ab li-x x x x
```

8

- **N:** […] … | i nīšib | wēdāni
- **T:** […] and let us sit down on our own.
- **L:** *i* ← i I “let's”; *nīšib* ← ašābu I “to sit (down)”; *wēdāni* ← ēdēnu I “alone M/NB + pers. suff. e.g. *ēdēnukka*, *ēdēnuššu* on his own”

```
BabaOB1 o 8. [x x x] x-ma i ni-ši-ib we-da#-ni#
```

9

- **N:** … […] … | ša erēnim | maṣṣa[r (|) qištim]
- **T:** […] of the cedar, the guardian [of the forest,]
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *erēnim* ← erēnu I “cedar OAkk *qišti e.* cedar forest”; *maṣṣa[r* ← maṣṣaru I “guard, watchman in comb., e.g. Am. *m. šarri* king's guard”; *qištim]* ← qištu I “pl. *qišātu(m)* forest, wood *q. erēnim* cedar forest”

```
BabaOB1 o 9. x [x x] x ša {giš}ERIN ma-ṣa-a[r qi₂-iš-tim]
```

10

- **N:** [… | i]ṣabbassu | […]
- **T:** […] will seize him […]
- **L:** *i]ṣabbassu* ← ṣabātu I “to seize, take”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 270]: “Cf. the later line *u ārid qištīšu iṣabbassu luʾtu* (SB II 229, 286)?”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "II" 229; cf. L I.4 SB "II" 286; cf. L I.4 SB "II" 294

```
BabaOB1 o 10. x [x x x i]-ṣa#-ba-at-su₂# [x x]
```

11

- **N:** … […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […,]
- **Note:** As noted by [RN2651: 12], these lines appear to parallel OB Ishchali 32′–33′.
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Ischchali" 32'; cf. L I.4 SB "V" 304

```
BabaOB1 o 11. x [x x x x] ni ip? pu x [x x]
```

12

- **N:** … […] … | sebet? (|) kiṣrī? | … […]
- **T:** […] *seven knots* … […]
- **L:** *sebet?* ← sebe I “f. *sebet(tu)* seven, *sebet ūmim sebe mušiātim* seven days (and)…”; *kiṣrī?* ← kiṣru I “pl. usu. m. knot”
- **Note:** [RN2651: 12] suggests reading *7?# ki?#-iṣ-ri hur!-ša!-ni!*, “seven mountain ranges.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Ischchali" 33'; cf. L I.4 SB "V" 307

```
BabaOB1 o 12. m[a-...] x 7?# ki?#-iṣ-ri ki-x x ba x x x [(x x)]
```

13

- **N:** zizānam | i[nēru | nāʾe]ram | mupparšam | mubatt[iram]
- **T:** The Cricket they [killed], the Screecher, the Flyer, the Worm,
- **L:** *zizānam* ← zizānu I “(a cricket)? jB”; *i[nēru* ← nêru I “to strike”; *nāʾe]ram* ← nā'eru I “roaring O/jB of lion (figure), deity”; *mupparšam* ← mupparšu I “flying, winged OB, jB”; *mubatt[iram]* ← mubattiru I “(a worm or grub)? jB”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 270]: “The word *zi-za-na-am* is curiously written, half on the tablet’s left edge. There are two possible meanings, (a) a kind of grasshopper or locust, well attested, and (b) a half-share or measure known only from the lexical entry *MSL* XVI, p. 162, *Nabnītu* XVII 238: ½.tar = *zi-za-nu*. Which is appropriate here — if either — is uncertain.” The new parallel in SB V 308 suggests the reading adopted [EJ].
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 19; cf. L I.4 SB "V" 308

```
BabaOB1 o 13. zi-za-na-am i-[ne₂-ru na-i]-ra-am mu-pa!-ar-ša!-am mu-ba-at#-t[i-r
```

14

- **N:** … […] …
- **T:** … […] …
- **Note:** See [RN117: 270]: “Perhaps *ha-[ar-ha-ra-am ma-ṣa]-ru qi₂-iš-tim*, with OB Ishchali 30', but the rest of the line is obscure.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Ischchali" 30'

```
BabaOB1 o 14. ha-[x x (x)] x-ru x x-tim ba-ṣu x ši im x ab x [x;]-im
```

15

- **N:** … […] … | inēr-ma | … [(…)]
- **T:** […] … he slew and…,
- **L:** *inēr-ma* ← nêru I “to strike”

```
BabaOB1 o 15. i-[x x (x)] x-am x x x-am i-ne₂-er-ma te-ri-ik [(x x)]
```

16

- **N:** i[nēr] | hamsīšu
- **T:** he [*smote*] five times.
- **L:** *i[nēr]* ← nêru I “to strike”; *hamsīšu* ← hamšīšu I “five times OA, O/MB”

```
BabaOB1 o 16. i-[ne₂-er?] ha-am-ši-šu-u₂
```

17a

- **N:** … | irtahiṣ || qištam | ša erēni
- **T:** …he went trampling through the forest of cedar,
- **L:** *irtahiṣ* ← rahāṣu I “to flood”; *qištam* ← qištu I “pl. *qišātu(m)* forest, wood *q. erēnim* cedar forest”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *erēni* ← erēnu I “cedar OAkk *qišti e.* cedar forest”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 300

```
BabaOB1 o 17a. di#-x# (x#) x# ir#-ta#-hi-iṣ qi₂-iš?-tam <ša> {giš#}EREN?#
```

17b-18

- **N:** mūšab (|) ilī | enunakkī || puzzuram | ipte
- **T:** he discovered the secret abode of the Anunnaki gods.
- **L:** *mūšab* ← mūšabu I “dwelling, domicile, abode”; *ilī* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *enunakkī* ← Anunnakkū I “(the) gods”; *puzzuram* ← puzzuru I “MB f. *punzurtu* concealed O/MB of divine dwelling”; *ipte* ← petû II “to open”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 270]: “OB Ishchali is similar (37'–8': *ir-ta-hi-<iṣ> qištam | mūšab Enunnakkī puzzuram ipte*), but what precedes and follows is different.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Ischchali" 38'

```
BabaOB1 o 17b-18. mu-ša-bi i-li | e-nu-na-ki pu-zu-ra#-mi ip-te
```

19

- **N:** waldam | ṣērim || mitlukam | ile”i
- **T:** The wild-born was able to give counsel,
- **L:** *waldam* ← waldu I “born OA, OB, M/jB”; *ṣērim* ← ṣēru I “back, upperside”; *mitlukam* ← malāku II “to discuss”; *ile”i* ← le'û I “to be able, powerful”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 OB "Harmal₂" 47

```
BabaOB1 o 19. wa-al-dam ṣe!-ri#-im# mi-it!-lu-ka-am i-le-ʾi₃
```

19b

- **N:** issaqar[am] | ana ibrī[šu]
- **T:** he said to his friend:
- **L:** *issaqar[am]* ← zakāru I “to speak, say”; *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *ibrī[šu]* ← ibru I “friend, colleague”

```
BabaOB1 o 19b. is-sa₃-qa₂-r[a-am] | a-na ib-ri-[šu]
```

20

- **N:** ina dunnīka-ma | maṣṣaram | tenēram
- **T:** ‘By your strength alone you slew the guardian,
- **L:** *ina* ← ina I “(*im-m*..., *ip-p*... etc.) in, on”; *dunnīka-ma* ← dunnu I; *maṣṣaram* ← maṣṣaru I “guard, watchman in comb., e.g. Am. *m. šarri* king's guard”; *tenēram* ← nêru I “to strike”

```
BabaOB1 o 20. i-na du-ni-ka-ma ma-ṣa-ra-am te-ne₂-ra-am
```

21-22a

- **N:** mīnû | ubaššakka || qištam | ša <erēni> | šunēl
- **T:** what can bring you dishonour? The forest of <cedar> wood (22) lay low!
- **L:** *mīnû* ← mīnu I “what? OAkk, OB, MA, Nuzi, NB in PN”; *ubaššakka* ← bâšu I “to be ashamed, come to shame”; *qištam* ← qištu I “pl. *qišātu(m)* forest, wood *q. erēnim* cedar forest”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *<erēni>* ← erēnu I “cedar OAkk *qišti e.* cedar forest”; *šunēl* ← nâlu I “to lie down (to sleep)”
- **Note:** See [RN117: 271]: “*GIŠ* is probably defective for *{giš}erēnim*. More is missing if the line is to make sense as it stands, so I presume that *šunēl* belongs at the end and has slipped to l. 22 by mistake.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L l.4 SB "V" 304

```
BabaOB1 o 21-22a. mi-nu-u₂-um u₂-ba-ša-ka qi₂-iš-tam ša {giš}<EREN> | šu-ne₂-el
```

22b

- **N:** šuwwiam | erēnam | šīham
- **T:** Seek out for me a tall cedar,
- **L:** *šuwwiam* ← še'û I “also *šê'u* to seek (out)”; *erēnam* ← erēnu I “cedar OAkk *qišti e.* cedar forest”; *šīham* ← šīhu I “grown (tall) Bab., NA of gods, men, physique”

- **Note:** See [RN117: 271]: “Von Soden (‘die dir nun gehört’) and Hecker (‘deine’) took the second word as the accusative independent possessive pronoun, evidently reading *ku-wa-a-am*. However, the expected form in OB is *kâm*. Bottéro (‘un Cèdre extraordinairement élevé’) evidently parsed it as the accusative adjective *šūpâm* (cf. Tournay and Shaffer: *šu-pi-a-am*), but the uncontracted form would be *šūpuʾam* not *šūpiʾam*. I suppose it to be the verb *šeʾûm* in the imperative of the rare II/1 stem, with a glide in place of the glottal stop. This couplet exhibits an emphatic alliteration on /š/ lacking in the later version, which has *ibrī nittakis erēna šīha / ša muhhašu šamê nakpu* (SB V 293–4).”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 314

```
BabaOB1 o 22b. šu-wi-a-am {giš}ERIN ši-ha-am
```

22c

- **N:** ša muhhašu | šamāʾī | šannu
- **T:** whose top vies with the heavens!
- **L:** *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *muhhašu* ← muhhu I “skull”; *šamāʾī* ← šamû I “mostly pl. tant. sky, heaven”; *šannu* ← šanānu I “to equal, rival”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 315

```
BabaOB1 o 22c–23. ša mu-ha-šu | ($___$) ša-ma-A.A ša-an-nu
```

23

- **N:** lūpuš | daltam || ša qanâ | rupussa
- **T:** I will make a door whose breadth is a reed-length,
- **L:** *lūpuš* ← epēšu II “to do”; *daltam* ← daltu I “f. door *d. šamê/erṣeti* cosmic door of heaven/underworld”; *ša* ← ša I “who(m), which”; *qanâ* ← qanû I “pl. m. & f. reed, cane”; *rupussa* ← rupšu I “width, breadth as dimension”
- **Note:** On the specific door described in these lines, and its counterpart in the Standard Babylonian version, see [RN2651: 12].
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 316

```
BabaOB1 o 24. lu-pu-uš {giš}IG ša qa₂-na ru-pu-us₂-sa
```

24

- **N:** ay irši | šagammam || sippam | lillik
- **T:** let it not *have* a pivot, let it travel (in) the door jamb.

- **L:** *ay* ← ai I “(before consonant), *â*, *ya* not”; *irši* ← rašû I “to acquire, get”; *šagammam* ← šagammu I “upper door hinge? O/jB”; *sippam* ← sippu I “(door-)jamb Bab., M/NA s. *bābāni*, to left and right of doorway”; *lillik* ← alāku I “to go”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 317

```
BabaOB1 o 25. a-a ir#-ši?# ša-ga-ma-am si-pa-am li-li-ik?#
```

25

- **N:** amāt (|) lētāša || qanâ | rupussa
- **T:** Its side will be a cubit, a reed-length its breadth,
- **L:** *amāt* ← awātu I “word”; *lētāša* ← lētu I “f. cheek”; *qanâ* ← qanû I “pl. m. & f. reed, cane”; *rupussa* ← rupšu I “width, breadth as dimension”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 317

```
BabaOB1 o 26. a!(DIŠ)-ma-at le-ta#-ša# qa₂-na ru-pu-us₂-sa
```

26

- **N:** ay iṭhēšim | ahûm || ilum | lirā[mši]
- **T:** may no stranger draw near it, may a god have love for [it!]
- **L:** *ay* ← ai I “(before consonant), *â*, *ya* not”; *iṭhēšim* ← ṭehû I “to be(come) near to, approach”; *ahûm* ← ahû I “outside(r), strange of person, also as subst. stranger”; *ilum* ← ilu I “pl. *ilū*, *ilānu* god, deity a or the god, also du.”; *lirā[mši]* ← râmu I “love Bab., NA of deity, person for king, brother, woman”

```
BabaOB1 o 27. a-a iṭ-he-ši-im a-hu-um i-lu-um li-ra-a[m!-ši]
```

27

- **N:** ana bīti (|) ellil | libil (|) pur[a]ttum
- **T:** To the house of Enlil the Euphrates shall take it,
- **L:** *ana* ← ana I “(*aš-š*... etc.) to, for (freq. abbr. *an*, with assimilation of *n*...”; *bīti* ← bītu I “m.”; *ellil* ← Ellil I “”; *libil* ← wabālu I “(*cf.* also *babālu*) to carry, bring”; *pur[a]ttum* ← Purattu I
- **Note:** See [RN117: 271]: “As read the genitive construct state *bīti* either (a) retains its case-vowel, exhibiting the old-fashioned ending (as in OB II 165), or (b) exhibits crasis, *bīt-Illil*. One might instead read *qá-ti*, ‘to the hands of Enlil’.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 318

```
BabaOB1 o 28. a-na bi-ti en-lil₂ li-be₂-el pu-ra-[a]t-tum
```

28

- **N:** lihdū-ma | ummān | nippuri[m]
- **T:** may the folk of Nippur rejoice,
- **L:** *lihdū-ma* ← hadû III “to be joyful, rejoice”; *ummān* ← ummānu I “f.”; *nippuri[m]* ← Nippur I
- **Note:** See [RN117: 271]: “An alternative but less plausible reading is *li-ih-du u₂-šu-um-gal NIBRU{ki}*, ‘let the dragon of Nippur become glad’.”
- **Parallels:** cf. L I.4 SB "V" 319

```
BabaOB1 o 29. li-ih-du-u₂-ma um-ma-an# NIBRU{k[i}]
```

29

- **N:** lirīssim | enlil
- **T:** may Enlil delight in it!’
- **L:** *lirīssim* ← riāšu I “to rejoice”; *enlil* ← Ellil I “”

```
BabaOB1 o 30. li-ri-is₂-si-im en-lil₂
```

30

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
BabaOB1 r 1. [...]
```

31

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
BabaOB1 r 2. [x x x] x x [...]
```

32

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
BabaOB1 r 3. [x (x)] x x x x [...]
```

33

- **N:** […] … […]

- **T:** […] … […]

```
BabaOB1 r 4. [x x (x)] x x x x x [...] | [...]
```

34

- **N:** […] … | ubbalaššināti | … […]
- **T:** […] … was carrying them … […]
- **L:** *ubbalaššināti* ← wabālu I "(*cf.* also *babālu*) to carry, bring"

```
BabaOB1 r 5. [x (x)] x ub-ba-la-ši-na-ti na-[x x x (x x)]
```

35

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]
- **Note:** See [RN117: 271]: "I did not quite see van Dijk's *i-de-el a-bu-ul* [*qištim*]."

```
BabaOB1 r 6. [x x x]-ak-bu i-di x x x [...] | [...]
```

36

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
BabaOB1 r 7. x# (x#) x# i-mi-dam-ma ni-x x x [...]
```

37

- **N:** […] … […] …
- **T:** […] … […] …

```
BabaOB1 r 8. [x x x]-ma me-e i-za#-x x x [x x x] x
```

38

- **N:** […] … […] …
- **T:** […] … […] …

```
BabaOB1 r 9. [x x x x] x-im-ma me#-e# i#-za#-x x [x x x] x
```

39

- **N:** […] … […] …
- **T:** […] … […] …

```
BabaOB1 r 10. i-x x x x-ma x x-ra-a [x x x x] x-im
```

40-47

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

48-57

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

58

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
BabaOB1 t.e. 1. [...]-ri#-im?# [(x)]
```

59

- **N:** […] … […]
- **T:** […] … […]

```
BabaOB1 t.e. 2. [...] x-ri-bu [(x)]
```